

ALLEYES ON MBAPPE AND CO.

With a stellar squad, France hopes to **win its first Euro title since 2000**, while the Netherlands, Poland, and Austria try to overcome concerns with injury and form.

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After narrowly missing out on consecutive World Cup victories, France will aim to establish itself as a dominant force in Europe.

Antoine Griezmann stressed that 'defence wins championships', but France will need to settle in on a back five when it begins its campaign on June 17. Didier Deschamps has repeatedly reshuffled his backline over the last 18 months following the high-profile retirements of goalkeeper Hugo Lloris and centre-back Raphael Varane.

Brice Samba is the favourite to don the gloves, while France hopes William Saliba can replicate his Arsenal form in the Les Bleus shirt.

France's 26-man squad will be the envy of its European rivals, boasting strong options in each position. Deschamps also made the surprise decision to include 33-year-old N'Golo Kante, who returned after a two-year absence despite moving to the Saudi Pro League last summer.

Kylian Mbappe, who replaced Lloris as skipper, was the top scorer in the European qualification with nine goals as France breezed through to the finals. The attack will be further strengthened by exciting additions like Ousmane Dembele, Marcus Thuram, Kingsley

Football royalty: France's 26-man squad, coached by Didier Deschamps (in white), boasts strong options in each position, led by captain Kylian Mbappe. GETTY IMAGES

Coman, and Bradley Barcola. France has all the attributes to go all the way and win its first Euro title since 2000.

Finding the Dutch flair

Ronald Koeman will have the opportunity to continue his work with the national team after returning for a second spell at the beginning of last year. He previously left the role after securing Euro 2020 qualification to take on the Barcelona job.

It hasn't been a smooth return, with the Netherlands losing to European heavyweights France, Italy, Croatia, and Germany — the latter three ranked below the Dutch.

Of the 26 players who featured in Qatar, only 15 will be heading to Germany. The midfield and goalkeeping departments have seen significant changes in the short